1.4.7 Pandemic management

As I was finishing writing this book, the once-in-a-century COVID-19 pandemic descended upon us, engulfing the planet. Every one of us got firsthand experience with a decentralized planetary-level problem. Everyone and every community was isolated, resulting in a decentralized world.

Although blockchain is well suited to solving many problems in this type of situation, I feel that it is ideally suited to performing a crucial task in mitigating the spread of this virulent disease: that of contact tracing. According to the U.S. Centers for Disease Control (CDC), contact tracing identifies cases by testing and tracing the source and pathway to the affected patient. This task of contact tracing is similar to tracking a fraction of a Bitcoin cryptocurrency to its origin. This trace for a cryptocurrency is recorded automatically on the DLT of the blockchain. Thus, blockchain infrastructure and DLT, along with the smart contract code collectively, could provide an innovative solution for contact tracing in an epidemic.

Another area in which blockchain can help is the transparent management of distribution of trillion-dollar aid packages and resource allocations. A significant outcome of the pandemic is the decentralized world, in which people are managing the situation themselves. Blockchain infrastructure is ideally suited to solve many problems in this environment.